

Systemic Grace

50-55 min · March Week 1

OBJECTIVE	Students extend the concept of grace from the interpersonal to the institutional and systemic — identifying how grace operates at the level of communities, organizations, and structures — and articulate one specific systemic grace contribution they are positioned to make.
DURATION	50-55 min · March Week 1
KEY VOCABULARY	systemic grace · structural injustice · institutional repair · collective accountability · grace at scale · reform vs. transformation
OPENING REVIEW	'Unit 3 ended with the Graduation of the Heart. Unit 4 begins today. The question changes one final time: not what do I do with the people who hurt me, not who am I becoming — but what will I build? Today: grace at scale.'

ANCHOR CHART

SYSTEMIC GRACE PERSONAL GRACE: A deliberate extension of goodwill to one person. (Books 4-5)
 COMMUNITY GRACE: A culture where goodwill is the default assumption. (Book 4, Unit 4) SYSTEMIC GRACE: Grace built into the structures, policies, and practices of institutions. Where repair is expected. Where accountability is restorative, not punitive. Where the most vulnerable members are protected by design, not by charity. SYSTEMIC GRACE IS NOT: Ignoring structural harm and calling it forgiveness · Excusing institutional failure in the name of compassion · Performing grace while structural injustice continues. SYSTEMIC GRACE IS: Accountability structures that produce repair, not just punishment · Policies that extend the same goodwill to all members as default · Institutions whose operational values match their stated ones · The person who knows what the institution is supposed to be — and holds it accountable to that. POST: Before class. KEEP: Unit 4.

OPENING RITUAL

90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 15 seconds.] 'Unit 4 begins today. This is the final unit of Book 5 — and of the entire Architecture of Grace curriculum. Everything that was built in Books 1 through 5 leads here. Not to a conclusion — to a beginning. What will you build with everything you have been given?' [Post: 'What will the world be like because you were in it — and what are you willing to do to build that world?']